

Transitions & signal words - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Library Rooms

The library added two reservable study rooms this semester. weekend reservations filled within the first three days.

1. Which transition best connects these ideas? "The library added two reservable study rooms this semester. ____, weekend reservations filled within the first three days."

- A. For example
- B. However
- C. As a result
- D. In addition

2. What relationship should the transition signal?

- A. simple addition with no contrast or cause
- B. example
- C. an example of the first idea
- D. a chronological step with no logical relationship

Solar Canopy

The parking-lot canopy cost more to install than a standard shade structure. it now generates electricity while shading parked cars.

3. Which transition best connects these ideas? "The parking-lot canopy cost more to install than a standard shade structure. _____, it now generates electricity while shading parked cars."

- A. As a result
- B. For example
- C. However
- D. In addition

4. What relationship should the transition signal?

- A. simple addition with no contrast or cause
- B. an example of the first idea
- C. a chronological step with no logical relationship
- D. contrast

Road Salt

Salt can lower the freezing point of water and improve winter road safety. heavy use can damage roadside plants and enter streams.

5. Which transition best connects these ideas? "Salt can lower the freezing point of water and improve winter road safety. _____, heavy use can damage roadside plants and enter streams."

- A. However
- B. As a result
- C. For example
- D. In addition

6. What relationship should the transition signal?

- A. simple addition with no contrast or cause
- B. contrast / qualification
- C. an example of the first idea
- D. a chronological step with no logical relationship

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. The second sentence gives a specific result that illustrates strong demand.
2. B. The second sentence gives a specific result that illustrates strong demand.
3. C. The second idea presents a benefit that contrasts with the higher initial cost.
4. D. The second idea presents a benefit that contrasts with the higher initial cost.
5. A. The second sentence limits the positive first idea by introducing an environmental drawback.
6. B. The second sentence limits the positive first idea by introducing an environmental drawback.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.